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r/GooglePixel • 1y ago

demox1321 Pixel 9 Pro XL



My Google Pixel Might Have Saved My Life Last Night - Seriously! (Drunk Driver Involved)

Hey everyone, I just had a terrifying experience last night and I honestly believe my Google Pixel's crash detection feature might have saved my life. I feel like I need to share this urgently.

It was around 4 am and I was driving home from north Denver near 470 . The roads were very dark and a little damp from earlier rain. I was just cruising, tired but focused on getting home.

Then, it happened. One minute I was driving, the next, I saw headlights reflecting off something dark directly in my lane. It was a grey sedan just sitting there, completely unlit in the middle of the highway. I had maybe a split second to register what was happening before impact. My brakes were useless at that point. Everything went black the instant before I hit it. I honestly barely remember the impact itself.

The next thing I knew, I was coming to, disoriented and in pain. My airbags had deployed, and my phone had flown somewhere in the chaos. I was still trying to figure out what had just happened when I heard a voice. It was my Google Pixel Assistant, saying something like, "It looks like you've been in an accident. I'm going to call emergency services if you don't respond." I was still incredibly groggy, but I must have mumbled something or stayed silent, because the phone took action.

Within what felt like minutes (though it could have been longer), I heard sirens getting closer. When the paramedics and police arrived, they told me that 911 had received an automated call from my phone reporting a crash at my exact location. They knew there was an accident and where to find me, even though I was in no state to call for help myself.

What's even more disturbing is what the police told me later. The driver of the car I hit was heavily intoxicated and had apparently just been involved in another collision further back on the highway before inexplicably stopping in the middle of the road. He was a danger to everyone out there.

Honestly, thinking about what could have happened if my phone hadn't done that sends chills down my spine. I was unconscious or barely conscious, alone on a dark highway in the wee hours, after being hit by a drunk driver. Who knows how long I would have been there, injured and vulnerable, if it weren't for that feature. I'm still processing everything and dealing with some minor scrapes and bruises. But I am so incredibly grateful for the technology in my pocket.

So, if you have a Google Pixel, please, please make sure your crash detection is enabled! It's not just a gimmick; it might literally be the thing that gets you the help you need when you can't ask for it yourself.

Stay vigilant and safe out there, everyone. You never know what you might encounter on the road.

Edited for formatting



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1.9K

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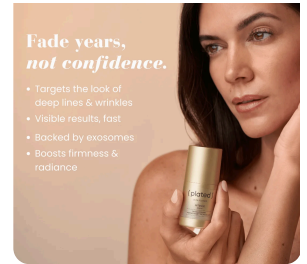
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jcolby603 • 1y ago

Pixel Watch 3 45mm

Wow, glad you're ok.

Just double checked and I have it enabled.



dwp1956 • 1y ago

Me too. Didn't even know I had it. Thank you!



DSCarter_Tech • 1y ago

Pixel 8 Pro

Yet another Pixel feature which needs to be opt out instead of opt in



vawlk • 10mo ago

Pixel 5

mine was off and I never turned it off.



DSCarter_Tech • 10mo ago

Pixel 8 Pro

If you ever leave your home country, it sometimes gets disabled.



PalolisForever • 10mo ago

Pixel 9 Pro Pixel Fold Pixel Watch 3 45mm LTE

Yes, but it gets re-enabled automatically as soon as you turn off Airplane Mode when you land in the US.

I have seen this multiple times.



4 more replies



2 more replies



1 more reply

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I wish it was available in more places, to me it tells it's not available, only supposed to work in uk and usa? But it does not work even when I am currently in UK as I am not on UK carrier sim card



Exerra • 10mo ago

Very disappointed this feature isn't available in Latvia. Absolutely no reason for it to not be available. I guess the idea is that it can't make a call in Latvian, but I imagine emergency services understands English well enough to figure out what's happening (even the older population knows the words car and crash).

All of this geo restricting makes me regret buying the Pixel. No fancy features, really bad customisation, worse performance, bad Find My network (compared to Samsung). Only thing that Samsung doesn't have an advantage in is the camera. Absolutely everything else is either worse or not available in my country.



vawlk • 10mo ago

Pixel 5

likely due to the more strict EU rules...



Exerra • 10mo ago

Maybe. Though 2 features are available in EU countries, but not where I live.

Call screening is available in Germany and France.

Car crash detection is available in Austria, Belgium, Denmark, France, Ireland, Italy, the Netherlands, Norway, Portugal, Spain and Sweden.

On iPhone the car crash detection works basically everywhere from what I can tell. Was day 1 enabled for me, at least.



onoz9 • 10mo ago

Yeah. Google treats most European countries like 3rd world. Baltic countries only recently become officially supported and can now use 5G. They couldn't before, which is crazy. But most of Eastern Europe still isn't in this list. Call screening and crash detection are also very limited. And if you have to send your phone in for warranty repair, prepare for a lengthy and painful process, as it has very limited support and you'd have to send your phone god-knows-where...

I previously used Pixel phones but switched to iPhone in March and honestly, I am very happy. Not only is it much quicker and smoother and has a much better battery and modem, it has better support and crash detection. iPhone does not have call screening anywhere but you can filter out calls from numbers not in your contacts and e-mails.

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It works for me in Austria.

[+ 2 more replies](#)



Fatbloke-66 • 10mo ago

I didn't have it turned on. Now active!



postnospam • 1y ago

Pixel 4 XL

Glad you're okay! Sounds like it could have been much worse.

Had car crash detection come to my rescue a few years ago when my skid steer loader rolled off an embankment. I was unconscious for several minutes and my phone had been tossed from the cab.

Like you, I felt it was important to spread the message to make others aware of the feature and came to Reddit to share. About a year and a half later, I was contacted by a talent recruiter looking for people who had been assisted/saved by car crash detection. A few months later we had a full blown production crew on our property filming!



DSCarter_Tech • 1y ago

Pixel 8 Pro

Is the commercial available?



postnospam • 1y ago

Pixel 4 XL

It was 14 hours of filming for a 53 second video <https://youtu.be/Wlb3qOVukaY?feature=shared>



marcsto • 1y ago

Big thank you for filming this! I teared up the first time I watched it. Fun fact: I put up a framed version of your original reddit post in our office at Google (I lead the team that invented car crash detection). It was the first time we heard from someone who had been saved and it really meant a lot to everyone to hear your story. Great to hear from you again!



postnospam • 10mo ago

Pixel 4 XL

My family and I can't thank you and your team enough! This is truly life changing technology.

It's been a while since I've watched the video and it still gives me goosebumps. Not a word of that video was scripted. The audio was recorded the day before filming. Getting all of it out was a great therapy session.

[Skip to main content](#)[+ Create](#)**iheartgoobers** • 10mo ago

That has to be so gratifying!

**postnosspam** • 1y ago

Pixel 4 XL

This was the original Reddit post https://www.reddit.com/r/pixel_phones/s/3iwKNskF94

**ObscureSaint** • 1y ago

Pixel 10 Pro

This is the post that made me activate mine!

**d0xxx** • 1y ago

Would it go off in a mosh pit at a concert?

**demox1321** **OP** • 1y ago

Pixel 9 Pro XL

I've had mine in mosh pits be it knocked loose to lamb of god and it didn't go off.

**buncharobots** • 1y ago

👍 👍 glad things weren't any worse OP. Hope you're back in the pit before too long.

**GearM2** • 1y ago

Pixel 9 Pro XL

I doubt it unless you're in a mosh pit in a moving semi trailer or something. Both Android and iOS devices have been know for false positives when detecting car crashes but I think those are pretty rare. I believe they use a combination of sensors such as accelerometer and GPS. If you just chuck your phone at a wall it shouldn't think you were in a car crash. If you are driving down the highway and chuck your phone hard to the back seat or something then come to a stop then I could see it thinking you crashed. Maybe someone has some actual experience moshing with this feature on?

**sandmyth** • 1y ago

I think many of the false positives for iPhone were roller-coaster related.

**Academic_Enthusiasm6** • 1y ago

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had a flicker and I didn't know it had that feature so it started the crap out of me.

**GearM2** • 1y ago

Pixel 9 Pro XL

Yeah I think that makes sense though because you were moving (as in recently travelling at speed), then you came to a stop and the phone had some jarring motion when it fell.

**Academic_Enthusiasm6** • 1y ago

That's when I figured the phone knows you're driving due to GPS/speed. So anytime the accelerometer gets a decent jostle AND the GPS tells the phone you've come to a stop it trigger it. Because I had inadvertently chucked my phone MANY times before that. Cause I am a clutz.

**techraito** • 1y ago

Pixel 9



Top 1% Commenter

No, the phone knows you're driving because it can sorta feel when you're going 20mph or more

**Pentosin** • 10mo ago

8Pro to 10pro XL

Feel... It has gps.

**techraito** • 10mo ago

Pixel 9



Top 1% Commenter

No actually feel. Some of the later pixels use AI to detect rumbling and whatnot for car detection.

**Pentosin** • 10mo ago • Edited 10mo ago

8Pro to 10pro XL

Its not sentient. It cant "feel" if you are going faster than 20mph. Thats what gps is for. And for change in acceleration(like in a crash), it does have accelerometers for instance.

**Goldglove528** • 10mo ago

One day they'll have secrets. One day they'll have dreams.



4 more replies



1 more reply

**islandthunder88** • 1y ago

I've had mine go off during a run and golf swing. Both were easy to dismiss, my moshpitt days are

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[windowscentral.com](#)[Syncroz](#) • 1y ago

So glad to hear when this feature works.

3 years ago I had a similar experience but on my Garmin bicycle computer, paired to a pixel 6, it detected my crash and texted my wife through the pixel my GPS coordinates and a map. When I didn't answer the phone she called 911 and met the ambulance at the park gate and took them to me.

I'm glad to hear if it ever happens again, or in a car, the pixel can handle it on its own.

[iheartgoobers](#) • 10mo ago

Lol I've unfortunately had several crashes on my bike, and my Garmin either fails to recognize them, or, the one time it did, it said it would call and then said, nope that didn't work. Weak.

Needless to say I don't have a ton of confidence in that Garmin feature...

[+](#) 1 more reply[CoLdFuSioN167](#) • 1y ago

Pixel 9 Pro XL

I got into a car accident 2 years ago and my Pixel went flying across my dashboard. It automatically started emergency services and got a 911 operator on the line. It was great because I was all shaken up and couldn't think straight. Definitely helped me out!

[acid-burn2k3](#) • 1y ago • Edited 10mo ago

I had goosebumps reading this. Your own phone taking care of yourself, I don't know why it wet my eyes. There is something beautiful in that.

You know I imagine your phone half-cracked, with it's last failing battery due to the shock of the impact. Then you hear it from far away, "...just had an accident. If-you-dont-answer-I'm going to calll-bzrritrzrrz-911-for_you"

[Skip to main content](#)[+ Create](#)**_wolf** • 1y ago

That's amazing news. I always had a question, does that crash detection feature require mic access to be enabled?

**demox1321** **OP** • 1y ago

Pixel 9 Pro XL

I'm actually not quite sure I assume yes just because it will call 911 if not responded to by voice or manual deactivation.

[+ 2 more replies](#)**nivse** • 10mo ago

Pixel 8 Pro

Thanks for sharing the story! Sadly, the feature isn't available in my language and country.

**u/GLiNet_WiFi** • Promoted

Ultra-low latency for real-time remote control

gl-inet.com[Learn More](#)**ronf1011** • 1y ago

It's good to enable crash detection and I think you have to have location set to full blast too

**[deleted]** • 1y ago

God bless you I am happy you are alive. Thankful the pixel is your phone as it is mine too

**metal_head23** • 1y ago

Glad you are okay brother. I just looked up my safety settings and switched the crash detection on.

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Watch with even more safety features!



RandomDude04091865 • 1y ago

I had no idea this feature existed, nor was it turned on when I looked. Thanks for spreading awareness!



RUMD1 • 1y ago

Pixel 9 Pro XL

It's funny that Google had this feature before Apple, but contrary to Apple, there isn't much info / tests about it, so reading that it really works feels great!



theY4Kman • 1y ago

Hell yeah! I listen to the police scanner a lot, and I occasionally hear these calls come over dispatch. Haven't heard any false positives. It's such an amazing feature to have on the devices we keep on our person.

(I *have*, however, heard countless false positives from the "emergency call" feature of phones — mostly iPhones and Apple Watches, unfortunately. Dispatch here, and hopefully everywhere else, too, takes an open line very seriously. The false positives are just mistakes, but know that if you feel you are in danger, simply calling 911 and leaving the line open in your pocket is enough.)

(Also, if you're gonna do something illegal, maybe disable your tap-to-turn-screen-on feature, lest it call emergency services in your pocket and bring John Ranger right to your door :P)



sweetestlorraine • 1y ago

Thank God you're safe.



[deleted] • 10mo ago • Edited 9mo ago

cagey wide sort sink teeny unite alleged memory steer simplistic

This post was mass deleted and anonymized with [Redact](#)



Leoneo07 • 1y ago

Man... I just activated mine. Thank you for this post and I hope you are feeling better.



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tucked up is that.

**spaceman757** • 10mo ago

Pixel 9 Pro XL

I was going to post the same thing. I'm guessing it is due to differences in the way that emergency services are setup/handled.

**F-35Nerd** • 1y ago

Pixel 8a

go buy it a new case as a reward!

no seriously, its amazing. had a crash two years ago, and my old 6a was screaming almost instantly. thankfully others had stopped and called 911 so i could turn it off on my end, but it had already alerted my family so they knew i'd been in a crash before i even got out of the car and took out my phone to call my dad. it also kept location sharing until i manually turned it off a few hours later even though i told it i was fine

**marcsto** • 1y ago

I'm really glad you're OK! Thank you so much for sharing your story.

**[deleted]** • 1y ago

Thank you for sharing. Glad you are okay! I didn't know you had to enable the setting. So mine is now setup!

**CoarseRainbow** • 1y ago

Mine went off when i fell over snowboarding with no injury.

It did however fail to go off in an actual car crash.

**Hyderite** • 10mo ago

Pixel 9 Pro

It doesn't work in my country :(

**HeadInhat** • 10mo ago

Not available in Croatia 🙄

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Pixel 9

It's not available in my country



ralphonsob • 10mo ago

after being hit by a drunk driver.

To be technically correct, it appears it was OP who hit the (stationary) drunk driver.

But I'm glad this feature worked.



ReAndro • 10mo ago

Crash Detection not available in all countries.



Former_Stomach8126 • 10mo ago

Too bad is not working all around the world.



basictutorial • 6mo ago

Bro got featured in Made By Google official live



Equivalent_Move8267 • 1y ago

Inspirational.

Glad you're alright bud.



NeuroDetergent • 1y ago



aeon100500 • 10mo ago

this feature is unsupported in my country, can't even enable it. 3rd world country residents are not valuable i guess



mrandr01d • 1y ago

Top 1% Commenter



Create



My phone did get sent through.

Glad yours did, and glad you're ok.

I'm also reminded of a video Joanna Stern did comparing crash detection using go carts (?) and they couldn't get anything to trigger when they wanted it to. The signals the system uses to determine if it's been in an accident must be rather complicated.

[deleted] • 1y ago



coolestredditdad • 1y ago

So glad you're ok. Great outcome to the story and I hope that driver feels the full weight of the law.



matttwhite • 1y ago

Technically, you hit a drunk driver.



[deleted] • 1y ago

Thank God I live in a walkable city



lone-Archer0447 • 10mo ago

There apps that do the same thing now.

[deleted] • 1y ago

NeuroDetergent • 1y ago